



Conditions attached to the gift

MERIDIAN / OCT 30, 2026 / F1

Agreement status	Unsigned / awaiting acceptance
Announcement	After the private toast
Attached papers	Trust, budget, invoices, accession file

Grant Larceny collapsed after the private toast and has died. Until the investigators finish their findings, preserve the service materials. His unsigned gift agreement would rename the museum, grant him acquisition vetoes, and require Artie's resignation. The related papers include a trust amendment, withheld invoices, disputed ownership files, and proposed cuts to education. These conditions were scheduled for announcement tonight.



Reference room incident notice

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Visitor permission	All gala guests
Missing material	Contents of the sole C-17 vial
Initial action	Room locked; vial preserved

All gala guests were invited to the preparation walkthrough. The shared room and reference cupboard were open to visitors. After the walkthrough, the steward discovered the C-17 reference vial empty and secured the room. The vial and service materials have been preserved for comparison. The inventory discrepancy is being investigated. A missing reference material is not, by itself, a finding about the cause of death.



The two service bells

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First bell / 6:40	Coupe unwrapped; table accessible
Second bell / 6:44	Numbered dome seal applied
6:46	Seal opened; cordial poured
6:49	Grant drank from the coupe

The initial examination found C-17 inside Grant's coupe. The communal cordial and food controls were clear. Service account: The coupe arrived in blue factory film with a white crest across the closed seam. I guarded that package during paper deliveries. At the first bell, 6:40, I cut through the crest, unwrapped the coupe, and left it unattended on the service table. At the second bell, 6:44, I sealed a clear dome over it. I watched the intact seal until the 6:46 pour and watched the glass until Grant drank at 6:49. Nobody substituted a vessel. Guests delivered papers before and after the open period too.



One vial, one missing sample

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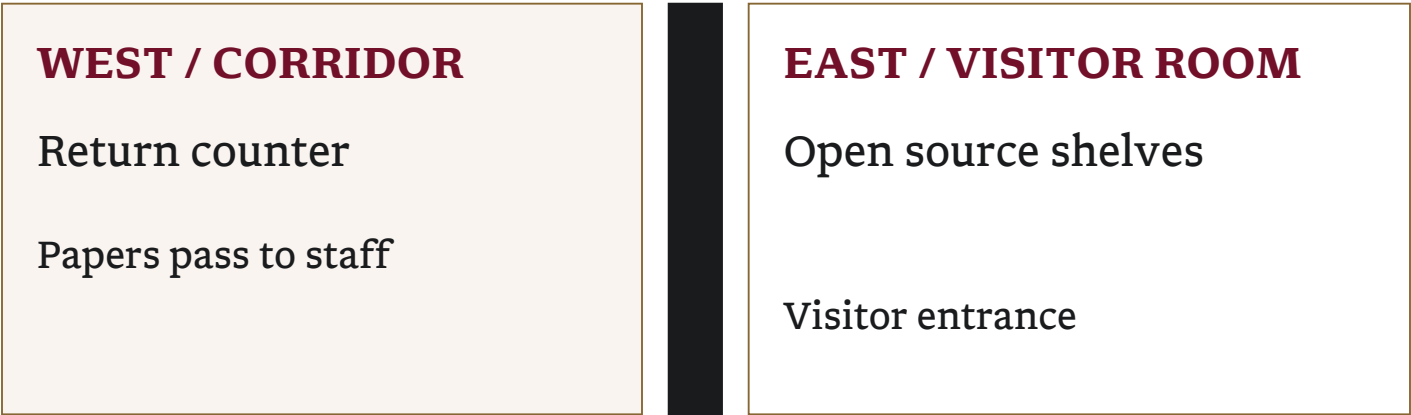
6:20 / room opened	Vial full; original seal intact
6:28 / room closed	Vial empty; cupboard secured
Source comparison	Unique C-17 reference batch

The steward inspected the sole C-17 vial full and sealed when the preparation room opened at 6:20. It was empty at the 6:28 closure. The cupboard was accessible only during that walkthrough. Laboratory comparison identifies the distinctive C-17 batch in the material recovered from the coupe. The batch log records one sealed vial of this formulation prepared for tonight's walkthrough. No other aliquot was issued. The room was locked after closure; nobody could obtain it later.



Preparation department / access plan

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FIXED BARRIER

- | | |
|------------------------------|---|
| East visitor entrance | Only guest route to the open shelves |
| West return counter | Outside the fixed barrier; staff exchanges only |
| Source cupboard | Visitor side / open 6:20–6:28 |

The west counter is in the corridor, separated from the preparation shelves by a fixed solid barrier. The staff return slot passes loan papers and support sleeves; it does not give guests access to the cupboard. Staff did not issue or pass C-17 through that slot. Guests entering the east visitor door could reach the open cupboard during the walkthrough. The source was unavailable before opening and after closure.



The poison was on the vessel

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Coupe interior

C-17 detected

Decanter and food

C-17 not detected

Service dome

Seal intact until witnessed opening

C-17 was present on the inner surface of Grant's private coupe, beneath the cordial line. The communal decanter, food, serving utensils, and poured cordial control were free of C-17. The coupe's guarded transport film excluded interior access before the first bell; the intact service dome and continuous watch excluded later contamination. The solution was deliberately applied directly inside the open coupe between the two bells, before the pour.



Packaging and receiving desk log

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FACTORY FILM



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Crest crosses joined seam

REUSABLE FELT



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Crest stitched into fabric

Transport covering

Blue factory film / crest crosses sealed seam

Table mat

Blue reusable felt / stitched crest

RECEIVED embossing

First impression at 6:45

The original transport film stayed sealed until the first bell. Its factory crest crossed the closed seam; the recovered film bears the cut made during unwrapping. The felt mat has a stitched crest and no sealed seam. The receiving clerk activated the raised RECEIVED seal at 6:45, after the second bell and dome seal. Earlier working carbons and red-pencil corrections have no raised impression. Originals were embossed individually on presentation; a carbon copy is not an embossed original.